

Journey Glitchless Speedrun Bible



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A complete guide to mastering the Journey glitchless speedrun

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Chapter 1

Chapter Select

1.1 Introduction

This was written because the guide I wrote on Speedrun.com¹ was written 4 years ago and is outdated. The routes have changed, new techniques have been discovered and more indepth research has been conducted on specific mechanics. I will be making a companion video to this as reading an entire pdf document can be a little boring and describing with words is harder than a video.

I want this guide to be as accessible to everyone as possible which is why I have a public repository on github where this guide can be updated in the future by anyone.

Run Setup

Glitchless runs can be slow. Especially redrobe runs. As such, playing offline or reducing your likley hood of running into another wayfarer mid run is essential.

PS3

Disconnect the network: Go to Settings < Network Settings < Internet Connection Settings and select Disable or Disconnect

PS4

Go to [Settings] < [Network] and uncheck [Connect to the Internet].
Alternatively, unplug your Wi-Fi router or the Ethernet cable from the back of the console

PS5

Go to Settings from your home screen. Select Users and Accounts, then click on Other. Choose Console Sharing and Offline Play and select Enable.

¹Charybdis2. *Journey Speedrun Guide*. 2021-08-14. URL: <https://www.speedrun.com/journey/guides/8yvqx> (visited on 08/02/2026).

PC: Steam

Click Steam (Top left) < Go offline.. Then run the game

PC: Epic Games

Menu < settings < preferences < enable offline mode

IOS

Go to Setting on your phone, enable airplane mode

This assumes that you don't need to play online to stream your attempts, as such the only games that can be played offline while streaming on the device are PC. This is why a capture card is recommended, but not required, as you can stream while remaining offline.

A way to reduce the likley hood of running into another wayfarer is that first time wayfarers cannot encounter whiterobes.

Input Preference

On Every platform you can use a controller to play, however on pc you may use Keyboard and mouse, and IOS you can use touch screen. There are pros and cons to every input device, however the main drawbacks from controller to Keyboard and mouse and less aparent in glitchless as the pressure of the movement stick is not as impactful here.

1.2 Scarf Infomation

Your scarf and it's length is probably the single most important mechanic in glitchless. This guide will be using the values that the game uses, These are abstracted by visually seeing the length of your scarf. This section heavily used some findings from Gadullus' wind theory² and my own.

A glossary for this section:

When I talk about **length** I mean the total capacity of your scarf at full charge.

Charge refering to current amount of length that you use while jumping.

The Charge System

- Redrobe you start with a length of 4
- Whiterobe you start with a length of 10
- Each symbol gives either +1 or +2 length, this pattern is alternating and the previous length given is remembered even after a chapter select reset.
- 1 Just costs 4 length, unless you are in whiterobe and your feet are touching the ground. In this case 1 jump costs 3.
- You cannot exceed a length of 30.
- Even if you only have 1 charge left, you can still jump.
- If you have 0 scarf and you pick up a symbol that symbol will give 4+1 (5) or 4+2 (6) depending on your cycle

To deduce what legnth the next symbol will give, Go to chapter select and pick up 1 symbol, If you can jump 4 times from the ground after picking up the symbol the next symbol will give +1, If you cannot jump 4 times (I.E 3) then the next symbol will give +2.

No. of Symbols	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
Red Robe +1 symbol first	4	5	7	8	10	11	13	14	16	17	19	20	22	23	25	26	28	29	30	30	30
Red Robe +2 symbol first	4	6	7	9	10	12	13	15	16	18	19	21	22	24	25	27	28	30	30	30	30
White Robe +1 symbol first	10	11	13	14	16	17	19	20	22	23	25	26	28	29	30	30	30	30	30	30	30
White Robe +2 symbol first	10	12	13	15	16	18	19	21	22	24	25	27	28	30	30	30	30	30	30	30	30

Table 1.1: Length of scarf after each symbol lookup table³

Total Length	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30
Red Robe No. Of Jumps	1	2	2	2	2	3	3	3	3	4	4	4	4	5	5	5	5	6	6	6	6	7	7	7	7	8	8
White Robe No. Of Jumps Not on the ground	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	3	3	3	4	4	4	4	5	5	5	5	6	6	6	6	7	7	7	7	8	8
White Robe No. Of Jumps from ground	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	3	3	4	4	4	4	5	5	5	5	6	6	6	6	7	7	7	7	8	8	

Table 1.2: Amount of jumps with each length lookup table

²Gadullus. *Snow winds theory: consequences on symbols gathered in white robe glitchless*. 2023-02-07. URL: <https://www.speedrun.com/journey/guides/gaux8> (visited on 08/02/2026).

Losing Scarf

There are two ways to lose scarf. Getting hit by a War Machine or winds. The winds are a bit special and will be covered in the Mountain section.

War Machines take half your scarf rounded down, so if you had 30, you will have 15, or if you had 3 you will have 0. War machines and the final wind are the only ways to get a total of 0 scarf.

How many symbols should you take?

In All symbols and scarfless this is irrelevant as you either take none or all of them. In any%, however you need to weigh the benefits of collecting symbols with the time it takes to collect them.

The current Any% route collects 7 symbols (2 in chapter Select, 3 in Pink Desert, 1 in underground and 1 in tower) These symbols are mostly on the direct route you take (Sunken City and Underground being the best examples) or are used in skips (Tower being the best example). The key difference with 7 compared to 8,9,10 or even 6 or below is the amount of jumps given and the total length. At 7 you gain 1 extra jump compared to 6 or below and you're 21 in length. This will be explained in the Mountain section about winds why this is important, but the key point is the final death march winds take 5 length off, so at 21 you need 5 winds to completely remove your scarf.

1.3 General Mechanics

Zen Jump

Press the screensaver button, and just before your screen turns totally black hit the jump button. Press the screensaver button again and view the result.⁴

An easier alternative to this is the zen drop⁵ when you are sliding in sunken city if you just hit the screensaver button without the jump, this will be slower than a zen jump but is more consistent.

This is currently used in one place, in Sunken city for all categories.

Animation Canceling

Walking up bolders or terrain you can cancel the slowdown of the stumble animation by chirping.

Frozen Running

Gaining extra height

You can gain extra height by walking off a ledge then jumping as aposed to just jumping.⁶ In the Video I use a little hop by running off the ledge to gain enough height so only two jumps are needed for the 2nd ledge.

Tandem Flying

A co-op exclusive trick allows players and their companions to stay in the air by charging each other.⁷

A version of this can be done at the end of a co-op run in mountain on the final walk, you can bunny hop

1.4 Chapter Select

Chapter Select is probably the easiest level. Time starts when you click chapter select. The only "Tech" to note in chapter select is you are able to move during the fade in from black

⁴Journey Wiki Contributors. *Zen Jump*. 2019-02-11. URL: https://journey.fandom.com/wiki/Zen_Jump (visited on 08/02/2026).

⁵Journey Wiki Contributors. *Surfing, Slides and Drops*. 2020-08-16. URL: https://journey.fandom.com/wiki/Surfing,_Slides_and_Drops#Zen_Drops (visited on 08/02/2026).

⁶Charybdis2. *Tower ledge fun*. Aug. 2, 2022. URL: <https://youtu.be/I1JgGJz1lMw?si=YWdOmUBXxz1ccU45&t=10> (visited on 08/02/2026).

⁷Journey Wiki Contributors. *Tandem Flying*. 2019-01-03. URL: https://journey.fandom.com/wiki/Tandem_Flying (visited on 08/02/2026).

Chapter 2

Broken Bridge

2.1 Redrobe Any% and All Symbols Route

2.2 Whiterobe All symbols Route

2.3 PS3 Route

2.4 Whiterobe Scarfless route

Chapter 3

Pink Desert

3.1 Triggers

Chapter 4

Sunken City

Chapter 5

Underground

5.1 Triggers

Chapter 6

Tower

Chapter 7

Mountain

The level, runs go to die.

Many Glitchless runners

7.1 Frozen

7.2 Winds

What level has the most RNG out of them all? Mountain.
What is the cause of this? The winds.

How do the winds work?

There are 12 different winds coded into the game, Each of these winds have different strengths, off times, peak times, sounds and affect your scarf in varying ways.

PLEASE NOTE THIS SECTION IS A WORK IN PROGRESS AND ANYTHING IN ITALICS IS UNCONFIRMED/GUESSING

What are the properties of each Wind section?

I will refer to the order in which you meet the winds from the start of the level playing normally (i.e no mountain skip).

There are two different winds in the first valley. The first wind you come across is labeled *WindBattle10 internally*, This wind is special as the strength of the wind is weak and if you do not jump, you can walk through the wind without being pushed back. Another quirk of this wind is you will not lose any length of scarf by standing in the wind.

The second wind in the first valley is labeled *WindBattle11 internally*, the rng *between*

blowing winds is about 2 seconds, If you stand in the wind, the wind will push you back and you will lose 3 scarf length. However if you have 16 or less scarf length you will not lose any more, however if you have 17, you will still lose 3 and go down to 14, if you have 18 you will go down to 15, and if you had 19 you will go down to 16.

I believe while you are walking past the heater station there is a wind pattern there. This is WindBattle12 and is permanantly blowing, however the stength is fairly weak.

Going into the patrol fields from the bridge there is a wind that takes off 2 scarf length. However if you have a scarf of length 11 or below this will not affect you. There is also a way to avoid this wind, by hugging the wall when doing mountain skip.¹ *Internally this is called WindBattle7*

The patrol fields use *WindBattle10* which does not consume any scarf length on wind.

Wind balcony uses *Either WindBattle1 or wbFortressStuff1:WindBattle3* and each wind consumes a scarf length of 3, with the total amount capped at 6.

Death march uses *WindBattle5* and each wind consumes 5 scarf length and there is no cap, so you can and will go to 0 scarf length. *The RNG between each wind can be between 9.5 and 0.25 seconds.*

What does this mean for a run? Well generally you want to have +1 over a multiple of 5 (6, 11, 15, 21, 26) In Whiterobe Any% the route mean you have 21 at the end, in scarfless you are capped at 10 which means you want to be 6 or above before death march, Which gives you one wind lee-way on the windy balcony, Similar to All symbols, as your capped at 30 you want to be 26 or above.

¹Gadullus. *Snow: Avoid Losing Scarf at Patrol Fields Entrance*. Jan. 8, 2023. URL: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7ne-AMTjfm0> (visited on 08/02/2026).

Chapter 8

Paradise

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